

the global population will be daily active users of multiple superapps, and that the superapp concept will also expand to include enterprise mobile and desktop experiences, such as workflow, collaboration, and messaging platforms.

The term superapp was first used to refer to WeChat, and later included other platforms like Alipay, Grab, Gojek, Rappi, and Snapp. Now, enterprises like Walmart and Uber are building their own superapps for their employees, partners, vendors, and customers.

Several Indian conglomerates like the Adani group, Reliance Industries, the Tata group, Paytm, Amazon India, and Flipkart are also attempting to build superapps, but, according to Inc42, “They are building large digital ecosystems with multiple services, but so far, no one has been able to position itself as the go-to platform commanding maximum stickiness.”

Perhaps they will benefit from this piece of advice from Gartner’s Top Strategic Technology Trends for 2023: “Offer an easy developer experience and convenient developer tools (such as APIs, design guidelines, software development kits, and frameworks) for partners to build, test, register, and submit min-apps for potential monetization.”

Platform engineering

Platform engineering is an emerging approach to improve developer productivity by providing them with reusable, self-service solutions (tools and processes) to produce good software with least overheads. The idea is to build an internal developer platform (IDP) that covers all the operational necessities across an application’s lifecycle, with the aim of reducing a developer’s headache!

“Platform engineering emerged in response to the increasing complexity of modern software

architectures. Today, non-expert end users are often asked to operate an assembly of complicated arcane services,” said Paul Delory, VP Analyst at Gartner, in a blog post. “To help end users, and reduce friction for the valuable work they do, forward-thinking companies have begun to build operating platforms that sit between the end user and the backing services on which they rely.”

**GARTNER EXPECTS
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DELIVERY.**

Github explains that, “Although some would argue a platform engineer is just another name for a site reliability engineer, the advent of complex new technologies—including Kubernetes, microservices, containers, and cloud orchestration—have pushed some companies to create a platform engineering team (or teams) charged with overseeing the platforms and the related technologies. In general, a platform engineer’s role is to help developers get software out the door more quickly and with security in mind.”

Gartner expects that by 2026, 80% of software engineering organisations will establish platform teams as internal providers of reusable services, components, and tools for application delivery, and that platform engineering will ultimately

solve the central problem of cooperation between software developers and operators.

Green and sustainable tech

With the climate crisis looming large, there is a lot of urgency to reduce carbon emissions. The world is also facing a major energy crisis as an outcome of the Russia-Ukraine war. This is leading companies to think about greenness and sustainability. They are exploring clean and sustainable sources like green hydrogen and decentralised power grids (distributed energy generation). They are experimenting with eco-friendly materials, doing everything they can to reduce the energy consumed by every component of a device. There is so much going on that we cannot fit it in this small space.

But... it is not enough if companies or tech makers alone think about this. To create any real impact, tech users must also think about this.

While power consumption of gadgets is the most evident aspect that most of us tend to think of, there is more to the sustainability puzzle. Have you thought of the rare minerals and natural resources used to manufacture components like silicon chips? Do you realise that most of your favourite cloud services run on large data centres that guzzle energy? When we say cloud services, we are not speaking of enterprise apps, but almost all the common apps you use, including Netflix and Spotify! So, almost every time you use an app of your phone or computer (even the search engine!), it is consuming energy. We know the tech companies will not like this, but let us request you, at the cusp of a new year, to pause for a moment and think about this the next time you pointlessly browse on your phone just to kill time, or change a properly functioning gadget just for kicks! **EFY**